

Tablets: When Size Matters

It is safe to say that, compared to smartphones, tablet sales in India have not picked up well. While the market is brimming with tablet devices of all sizes, price range and features, not many people are going for them. The reason for that can be debated, which we shall leave for another day. Right now, let's focus on what we need to look at when buying tablets

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I ndeed, one of the reasons for the lack of demand for tablets is their usability. While a phone is carried by everyone from a teenager to senior citizens, many are quite confused whether they should buy a tablet or not.

When it comes to tablets, there are different sizes available. While 17.8cm (7-inch) devices are often too small, it is the 25.4cm (10-inch) ones that really make the most sense. Why? Because anything beyond 15.2cm (6-inch) is a phablet, which can pretty much cover the work of a 17.8cm tablet as well. On the other hand, anything above 30.5cm (12-inch) is not quite as portable as you would want it to be.

To be or not to be

With the option to dock a tablet and 2-in-1 devices available, many believe that a laptop is truly a thing for the last generation to dwell on. But a laptop is



still useful in many situations.

Now, what do you use your laptop for? The most common usage today is to watch movies, audio chat or video chat with friends and family, and cook up documents on Microsoft Word. If this is the extent of your usage, then a tablet does make sense for you. These devices are cheaper than laptops and can do all of these things.

But, if your usage extends to audio editing, graphics, gaming or other advanced activities, you cannot do without a powerful laptop. Also, if you are working with a laptop on your desk most of the day, you may

not find it convenient to replace it with a tablet.

Wi-Fi or without Wi-Fi

Tablets come with Wi-Fi and without Wi-Fi. While the Wi-Fi variant will connect to the Internet only through Wi-Fi,

the other will connect using mobile networks. So, their usage is pretty self-explanatory.

You buy a Wi-Fi tablet if you have regular access to wireless connections. 3G tablets, on the other hand, are useful for those who need to use their device on the move, such as outdoor sales people and professionals.

If you want a tablet for basic requirements, you can most often do with a Wi-Fi-enabled device. All you have to do is download your e-books, movies etc in advance so as to use them while in transit.

If you are unsure whether either of these variants would fulfil your

TABLETS TO CHOOSE FROM

	iBall Slide 3G1035	Lenovo Yoga 10	Samsung Galaxy Note 10.1	Apple iPad Air	HP Omni 10	Asus Transformer Book T100
						
Price	₹ 17,999	₹ 22,999	₹ 49,990	₹ 44,900	₹ 27,900	₹ 34,000
Connectivity	2G, 3G, Wi-Fi	Wi-Fi	Wi-Fi/3G	Wi-Fi/3G	Wi-Fi	Wi-Fi 3G
Display	25.7cm (10.1-inch)	25.4cm (10-inch)	25.7cm (10.1-inch)	24.6cm (9.7-inch)	25.4cm (10-inch)	25.7cm (10.1-inch)
Processor	1.2GHz Cortex A7 quad-core	1.2GHz quad-core	2.3GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 800 quad-core	Apple A7 64-bit	1.4GHz Intel Atom Bay 3370 quad-core	1.86GHz Intel Atom Bay Trail 23740 quad-core
Operating system	Android 4.2 Jelly Bean	Android 4.2 Jelly Bean	Android 4.3 Jelly Bean	Apple iOS 7	Windows 8	Windows 8.1